

BRAND BOOK · EDITION 0.1 · 2026-05-13

NexaCore Brand Book

*Visual identity, voice, and applications for
NexaCore OS & NexaCore Foundation.*

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Why a brand book.

A brand book is a forcing function. It pins down decisions that would otherwise be re-litigated every time someone makes a slide, sends a press release, or files a grant cover letter.

This book is the public-facing surface of three documents that already exist in the NexaCore OS repository: the `README.md`, `docs/01-vision.md`, and `docs/05-governance.md`. It does not invent new positioning. It distills decisions already taken into a form that designers, developers, contributors, and external partners can apply without rereading the entire repository.

It is also a constraint document. The visual system, voice rules, and lexicon defined here are not suggestions. A draft that violates them is a brand error, and brand errors compound — they read as institutional drift, exactly the perception NexaCore OS is structurally designed to prevent.

How to use it

- **Developers** writing READMEs, NCIPs, ADRs, technical docs: refer to §3 (Voice rules) and §6 (Templates). Drop in the README header template and you are 80% there.
- **Designers** producing slides, social cards, marketing copy: refer to §4 (Visual system) and §5 (Iconography). Every asset linked is the authoritative source.
- **Foundation staff and trustees** producing annual reports, contracts, official correspondence: refer to §1 (Naming architecture) and §6.6 (Email signature). The full lockup with the Dutch legal form is the required first-mention pattern.
- **External partners and journalists:** the public version of this book lives at `nexacore-foundation.org/brand` (TBD). Press kit is in `brand/press-kit/` (Phase 4 deliverable, not yet shipped).

Authority and updates

The authoritative source of every chapter in this book is the linked file in the repository (e.g., `brand/STRATEGY.md`, `brand/colors/tokens.css`). Where this book and the source file disagree, the source file is authoritative — but in practice this book is regenerated whenever a source file changes, so the gap should remain zero.

Owner: Lead Architect (cySalazar) for years 1–5. After 2031-05-09, NexaCore Foundation Director. Review cadence: annually, or on any brand-affecting decision in `/docs/` or `/ncips/`.

PART 01 / 06

Naming & mission.

One product, two brands, a single mission. How NexaCore OS, NexaCore Foundation, and Stichting NexaCore relate.

§1 · NAMING ARCHITECTURE

Three names. One family.

NexaCore operates with three identities serving three distinct purposes — legal, brand, product. This separation lets each be optimized without compromise.

ROLE	IDENTITY	WHERE IT APPEARS
Product	NexaCore OS	Source code, technical docs, READMEs, CLI banner, kernel <code>uname</code> , releases
International brand	NexaCore Foundation	Website, social, press releases, sponsor materials, grant applications outside NL
Legal entity	Stichting NexaCore	KVK registration, notarial deed (statuten), Dutch tax filings, contracts, ANBI
Full lookup	NexaCore Foundation – Stichting NexaCore, Amsterdam — required first-mention pattern in formal materials	

Capitalization rules

- NexaCore is always set in all-caps. Treated as an initialism, not an acronym (we do not expand it).
- OS is always all-caps when paired with NexaCore. The two carry a non-breaking space (NexaCore OS).
- Stichting NexaCore — Dutch proper-noun convention; NexaCore Foundation — both words initial-cap on the second token.
- Possessive: NexaCore OS's kernel, never NexaCore OS' kernel.

"NexaCore Foundation legally is Stichting NexaCore. The split exists for the same reason Mozilla Foundation is just 'Mozilla' in the world."

One mission. Three voices.

Mission (funders & policy)

NexaCore Foundation develops and maintains NexaCore OS — an AI-native, privacy-by-construction, decentralized operating system — and stewards its governance in the public interest under an irrevocable Mission Anchor.

Vision (mainstream)

A world where everyone has the full power of modern AI on a computer they actually control.

Purpose narrative (about-page, manifesto)

The current generation of operating systems was designed before modern AI existed. Today AI capabilities are bolted on top — accessed through cloud APIs owned by a handful of companies, with the user's data as the implicit currency. We accept this because the alternative looks like running a model on a laptop with a fraction of the capability.

NexaCore OS proposes a different paradigm. AI runs locally by default. The operating system itself is the orchestrator. Computational scale is achieved by federating with other NexaCore OS instances over a peer-to-peer mesh — collective compute among people running the same software, not a service rented from a corporation. Privacy is not a setting in a menu; it is the only thing the protocol knows how to do. Non-compliant nodes cannot produce valid messages — it is mathematics, not policy.

We are building for the next 25 years. Stability of design comes before speed of delivery. Forks are welcome. The Foundation is structurally unable to capture the project.

PART 02 / 06

Personality & voice.

*Patient. Rigorous. Severe. Open. Honest. What we are — and
what we never are.*

§3 · BRAND PERSONALITY

Five attributes.

Each one tells you how to write a sentence and how to draw a panel.

Patient

25-year horizon phrasing. No urgency. Sunsets and dates anchored. Roadmap by quarter, not by hours.

Rigorous

Every claim names its mechanism. Numbers cited. Specs with line references. Visible grid in design.

Severe

Short sentences. No filler. Uncomfortable truths tolerated. No exclamation marks. Anywhere. Ever.

Open

Document the decision behind the decision. ADRs, NCIPs, signed commits. Source files ship next to artefacts.

Honest

Name the risks. `AWAITING_CRYPTO_REVIEW` markers stay until they don't apply. Status labels are document chrome.

Anti-personality

Never: excited, friendly-startup, cypherpunk-aesthetic, corporate-confident, crypto-finance.

What "anti-personality" looks like

WE ARE NOT	WHICH LOOKS LIKE
Excited	Exclamation marks · neon palettes · superlatives
Friendly-startup	"We love you" · mascots · rounded sans · gradients
Cypherpunk-aesthetic	Black/green CRT · Matrix references · glitch effects
Corporate-confident	Stock photography · testimonials · "trusted by" walls
Crypto-finance	Token charts · "decentralized" as marketing · web3 vocab · hex honeycomb



§4 · THE EIGHT VOICE RULES

How NexaCore sounds.

1. **Name the mechanism.** Don't say "secure"; say what makes it secure.
2. **Short sentences. Then a longer one for rhythm.** Average 14–18 words.
3. **No exclamation marks. Ever.** Including in error messages, social posts, and informal chat.
4. **No war / religion / sport / family metaphors.** No "battle", "tribe", "mission-critical sacred trust".
5. **The reader is competent.** Address developers and technical readers as peers.
6. **Sound the same in 5 years.** Avoid trend vocabulary ("vibes", "agentic", "moat", "10x").
7. **Hedge precisely or not at all.** "Probably secure" is forbidden.
8. **Cite yourself.** Use stable file paths, not floating descriptions.

The lexicon — owned vs. rejected

Owned

AI-native · local-first · privacy
by construction · mesh ·
attestation · TEE · peer-to-peer ·
compliance proof · Mission Anchor ·
25-year horizon · NCIP · BDFL
sunset · forks-welcome · quadratic
vote · proof-of-uptime

Rejected



blockchain · token · web3 · DAO ·
trustless · agentic · vibes ·
superhuman · 10x · moat ·
disruptive · bulletproof ·
military-grade · revolutionary ·
paradigm shift · mission-critical

"Privacy is enforced cryptographically — not by policy. A non-compliant node cannot produce valid mesh traffic."

§5 • MESSAGING HIERARCHY

From eight words to sixty seconds.

Five graduated messages, designed to be cut from — not paraphrased.

Tagline • 8 words

An AI-native operating system. Local-first. Decentralized.

Short-context tagline • for bios & signatures

Local-first AI for a computer you actually control.

Payoff • 16 words, sits under the wordmark

AI as a system primitive — running on hardware you own, federating with peers who prove their compliance.

30-second pitch

NexaCore OS is an AI-native operating system. It treats inference, model orchestration, and intelligent agents the way classical operating systems treat processes and files — as kernel-level primitives. AI runs locally by default. When you need more compute than your machine has, NexaCore OS federates with other instances over a peer-to-peer mesh of attested nodes — collective compute among people running the same software, not a service you rent. Privacy is enforced cryptographically at the protocol layer. We are building for the next 25 years.

PART 03 / 06

The mark.

Six federated peers around an irrevocable core. The geometry encodes the architecture.

§6 • VISUAL IDENTITY

The mark and its lockups.

Six petrol nodes represent federated attested peers. The central red dot is the Mission Anchor — irrevocable by design.

NexaCore OS • primary lockup



NexaCore OS

A project of NexaCore Foundation

NexaCore Foundation • sibling lockup



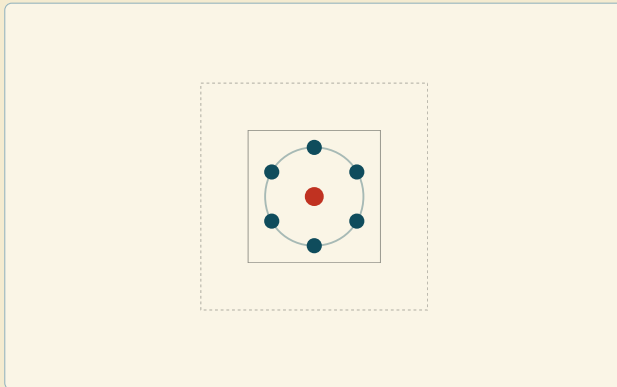
NexaCore FOUNDATION

Stewarding NexaCore OS in the public interest

Both lockups share the federated-ring mark — the deliberate sibling signal. The NexaCore OS lockup sits product-side; the NexaCore Foundation lockup sits steward-side. See [brand/logos/](#) for all variants (stacked, monogram, monochrome dark/light, full legal lockup with Dutch entity line).

§6 • VISUAL IDENTITY

Construction & clear-space.



Geometry

- 6 nodes · 60° spacing · starts top (12 o'clock)
- Node radius: 8 units (in a 140-unit mark)
- Core radius: 10 units
- Ring radius: 52 units
- Clear-space envelope: 1× mark-height on all sides

Semantics

The core (brick) is the Mission Anchor (Article 3 of the bylaws — irrevocable). The six nodes (petrol) are federated attested peers. The dimming envelope ring signals inclusion without coercion.

What you may never do

Recolor the mark outside the four sanctioned states (full color, monochrome dark, monochrome light, single-ink). ❌

Add **effects** — drop shadow, glow, bevel, gradient fill, animation in static identity. ❌

Change **proportions**. Six nodes only. Ring/node/core ratios are fixed. ❌

Flip, rotate, or invert. Orientation is fixed — one node always at 12 o'clock. ❌

Typeset NexaCore OS in a **different font**. Source Serif 4 700 is the only sanctioned wordmark. ❌

Crop the **wordmark** out of a primary or stacked lockup. Use the monogram if space is tight. ❌

§7 · COLOR SYSTEM

Palette.

Five families. One canonical of each. Brick is the only warm accent — and only when meaning demands it.



PETROL 500
#0F4C5C — primary brand hue



CREAM 300
#F4EBD0 — warm canvas



BRICK 500
#C03221 — Mission Anchor accent



SAGE 500
#7A9E7E — community / status-OK



CHARCOAL 800
#1F2421 — body text + dark surfaces

The single-red rule

Brick is the ONLY warm accent in the system. Sage warns/passes, charcoal carries, petrol leads. Brick is reserved for:

- The Mission Anchor dot in the mark
- Governance-status pills (`Vetoed` , `Critical`)
- `SEC-CRITICAL` , `AWAITING_CRYPTO_REVIEW` markers
- Roadmap phase indicators that intentionally signal "this matters"

Brick is never decorative. If a designer is "using brick to add warmth", they are misusing it.

Contrast on cream-300 canvas

FOREGROUND	RATIO	WCAG
charcoal-800 <code>#1F2421</code>	12.2 : 1	AAA all sizes
petrol-500 <code>#0F4C5C</code>	9.4 : 1	AAA all sizes
brick-500 <code>#C03221</code>	4.7 : 1	AA body · AAA large
sage-700 <code>#587657</code>	4.6 : 1	AA body · AAA large

Full contrast matrix: `brand/colors/palette.md` . CSS tokens: `brand/colors/tokens.css` . JSON tokens: `brand/colors/tokens.json` .

§8 · TYPOGRAPHY

Three families. One job each.

SOURCE SERIF 4 · 700 · DISPLAY

An AI-native operating system.

INTER · 400-500 · BODY & UI

A non-compliant node cannot produce valid mesh traffic — not because we say so, because the cryptography says so. **The reader is competent.** We address developers and technical readers as peers.

IBM PLEX MONO · 400 · CODE & METADATA

```
$ nexacore-mesh attest --tee tdx --quote ./quote.bin
> valid · trust-anchor: nexacore-fdn-2026
```

Why all three are SIL OFL

The codebase is AGPL-3.0; the protocol specs are CC0. Bundling a proprietary font would create a single non-open dependency in the brand layer that contradicts the project's posture. SIL Open Font License permits redistribution, embedding, modification, and forks. Forks of NexaCore OS can ship the same fonts without per-seat licensing.

Type scale · modular 1.250 (major third)

TOKEN	SIZE	USE
--nexacore-text-xs	12 px	Captions, metadata, footnotes, status pills
--nexacore-text-sm	14 px	UI default, table cells, secondary text
--nexacore-text-base	16 px	Body text default — minimum allowed body size
--nexacore-text-lg	20 px	Lede paragraph, callout
--nexacore-text-2x1	31 px	Page sub-headings (h2)
--nexacore-text-3x1	39 px	Page headings (h1)
--nexacore-text-4x1	49 px	Hero headings, blog title

PART 04 / 06

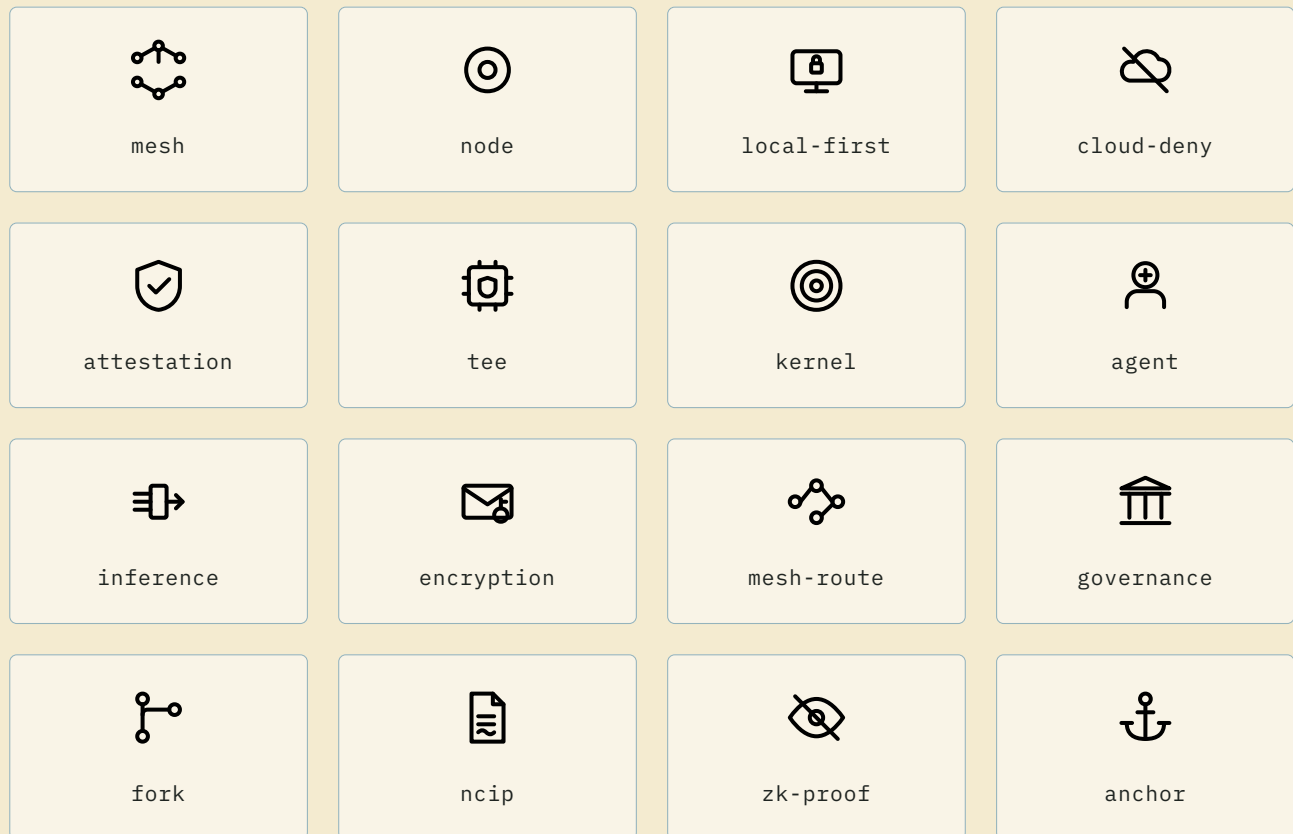
Iconography.

*Sixteen symbols. Single-stroke. No fill. Color inherited.
Index, never illustrate.*

§9 · ICONOGRAPHY

Sixteen concepts.

Each icon indexes a concept defined in the lexicon. Symbols are abstract — they do not illustrate.



Geometry: 24×24 viewBox · 1.5 stroke · round caps/joins · `stroke="currentColor"` . Source: `brand/icons/icons.svg` .

PART 05 / 06

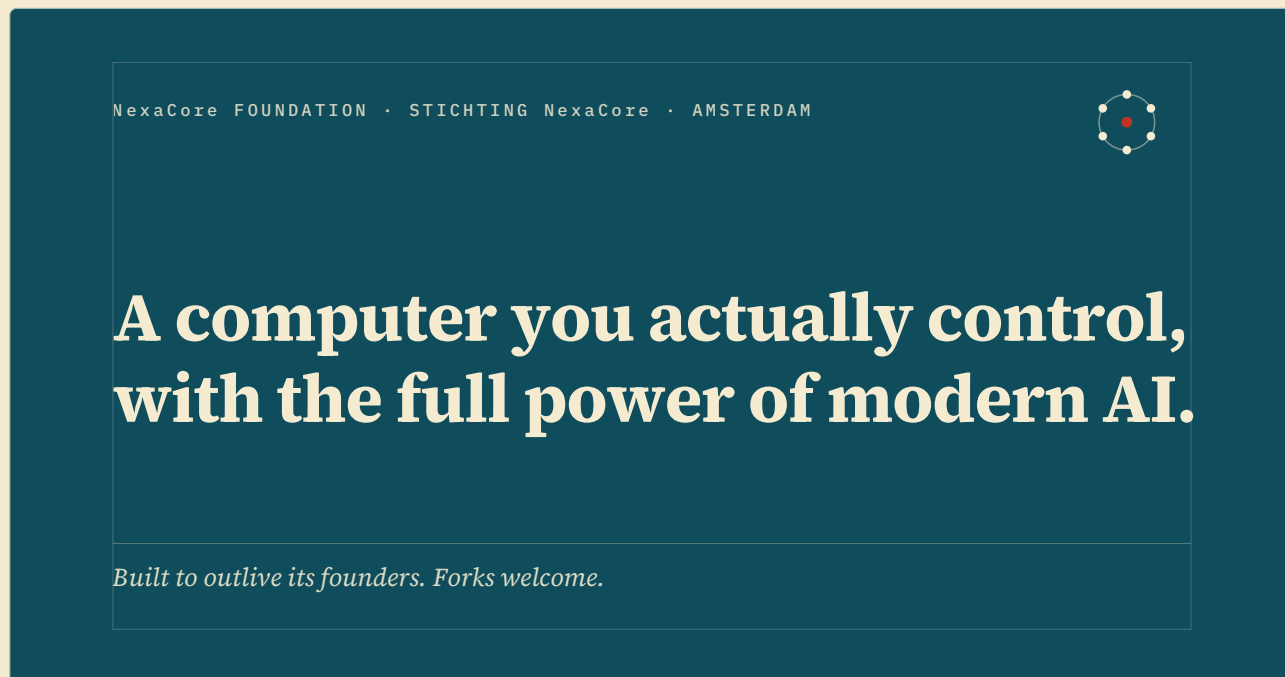
Applications.

Templates ready to drop in. The brand applied — not described.

§10 · APPLICATIONS

The brand applied.

Open Graph / social card (1200 × 630)



Template source: `brand/templates/social-card-1200x630.svg` . Edit the two `tspan` elements to customize the headline. Export to PNG at 1200×630 (or 2400×1260 for retina).

GitHub repository social preview (1280 × 640)

Template source: `brand/templates/github-social-1280x640.svg` . Upload via repository Settings → Options → Social preview.

Other templates

- `brand/templates/README-header.md` — repository README header block
- `brand/templates/slide-deck-starter.html` — single-file presentation deck
- `brand/templates/ncip-cover.md` — NexaCore Improvement Proposal cover
- `brand/templates/email-signature.html` + `.txt` — email signature (HTML and plain)

PART 06 / 06

Operating the brand.

Which brand goes where. Co-branding. Forks. How to contribute.

§11 · APPLICATION GUIDANCE

Which brand goes where.

CONTEXT	IDENTITY
Source code, technical docs, READMEs	NexaCore OS
Public website, social bios, blog	NexaCore Foundation (+ product NexaCore OS)
Press release (first mention)	NexaCore Foundation (Stichting NexaCore) , thereafter NexaCore Foundation
International grant cover letter	NexaCore Foundation
Dutch grant (NLnet, NL bodies)	Stichting NexaCore ("NexaCore Foundation")
Contract / commercial license	Stichting NexaCore
Annual transparency report cover	NexaCore Foundation – Stichting NexaCore, Amsterdam
Email signature (Foundation staff)	NexaCore Foundation Stichting NexaCore, Amsterdam

Co-branding

When acknowledging external entities (Open Philanthropy, NLnet, Mozilla MOSS, etc.), NexaCore is always the **anchor**, the external entity the **endorser**. Standard format:

```
NexaCore Foundation gratefully acknowledges [Funder] for [grant ID / project name].
```

Logo lockups: external logo to the right of the NexaCore Foundation wordmark, separated by a 2-rem rule. **Never composite logos with no separator**. Endorsement-of-the-month "trusted by" logo walls: forbidden. Funders are listed in the transparency report, not as decoration.

Forks & derivative works

Per the public trademark policy (Article 10.3 of the bylaws):

- Protocol-compliant forks **may** use the NexaCore OS name, encouraged to add a distinguishing qualifier (NexaCore OS – Acme Edition).
- Protocol-incompatible forks **may not** use NexaCore OS in their name. They may use derived from NexaCore OS .

- The Foundation will not initiate trademark enforcement against good-faith uses. Bad-faith uses (impersonation, regulatory fraud) addressed case-by-case.

§12 · CONTRIBUTING & CONTACT

How to contribute.

Brand changes follow the same review process as code. The brand is documented; the documentation is versioned; changes are signed.

Adding to the brand

1. If you are adding a new **concept** to the lexicon, propose it via PR to `brand/STRATEGY.md` §8 first. Lexicon precedes iconography.
2. If you are adding a **color token**, add it to `brand/colors/tokens.css` + `tokens.json` + the contrast matrix in `palette.md`, in that order.
3. If you are adding a **template**, follow the consumption pattern documented in `brand/templates/README.md`.
4. If you are adding an **icon**, follow `brand/icons/README.md` §"Adding a new icon".
5. Open a Draft PR. Sign your commits (DCO). Brand changes get reviewed by the Lead Architect (for years 1–5) or the Foundation Director (from 2031-05-09 onward).

Reporting brand misuse

Use of the NexaCore marks that violates the trademark policy or this book — by good-faith mistake or bad faith — can be reported to `brand@nexacore-foundation.org` (email TBD upon Foundation constitution; fall back to `cySalazar@cySalazar.com` until then). Good-faith corrections are resolved by documentation; bad-faith uses are addressed per the trademark policy.

Contact

cySalazar · `cySalazar@cySalazar.com`
`github.com/CySalazar/nexacore`
`nexacore-foundation.org` (forthcoming)

NexaCore Foundation · Stichting NexaCore · Amsterdam, NL

Colophon

This book was set in Source Serif 4 (Adobe, SIL OFL), Inter (Rasmus Andersson, SIL OFL), and IBM Plex Mono (IBM/Bold Monkey, SIL OFL). Direction C — Civic Tech / Generational. References include the design languages of Mozilla, Wikimedia, GOV.UK, the Internet Archive, and the Long Now Foundation. Authored by cySalazar for NexaCore Foundation, with the AI agent acting as drafting collaborator under the D.O.E. framework operative in this repository.